



Most Popular Games In India Aren't AAA Titles

As per the IMGR 2022 report, games like Carrom, Poker, Fruit Dart, Block Puzzle, Snakes & Ladders, and Ludo Dice are most popular. So, one might wonder – where are the AAA titles?

Our guess is that India is a price-sensitive market and gaming isn't still a serious hobby – let alone a career choice – for most people in the country. Gaming consoles like the PlayStation 5 and Xbox Series X are significant investments for the average Indian gamer, especially if you consider the cost of their accompanying games as well. Subscription models like PlayStation Now and the Xbox Game Pass are already making strides in allaying the community's hesitance to invest in gaming.

Key Factors in the Growth of the Indian Gaming Industry

- Increased connectivity and internet accessibility. This includes broadband, fibre and mobile data
- Affordability and choice of mobile phones
- The rise in purchasing power
- Digital literacy amongst the masses
- A cultural shift towards games being taken more seriously
- Gaming for leisure during the pandemic also enabled many of the above factors, in turn facilitating the growth of gaming

Trends in India for Gamers to Keep in Mind

- 5G network and 5G-supported smartphones could improve latency in games, especially eSports titles
- Integration of artificial intelligence into games could enhance the gaming experience going forward
- The pandemic shed light on streaming as a potential career choice, with gamers having realised its prospects and potential
- Government initiatives and increased investment from private parties can push the growth of the gaming industry

Concerns For The Gaming Industry

Addiction, cheating, betting, etc are some prevailing concerns for growth of the gaming industry. Rajeev Chandrasekhar, Minister of State for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship recently remarked the government is aiming to control “violence abetting video games, addiction to it, and consequential financial loss”. India could soon get transparent rules and guidelines for online gaming. This would clearly discern skill-based and chance-based games.

So even though the Indian gaming industry might be in a nascent stage compared to western countries, it is growing and showing a lot of potential. If the surging interest towards gaming gets backed by government initiatives favouring the gaming and animation infrastructure, we reckon things could only get better. Game developers, meanwhile, should design games that are culturally and contextually sensible to prospective Indian players from every nook and cranny of the country. *